

I'll use the new PDF's standard here too: broad family sweep, established constructions, specialist branches, register notes, distinctions, and a master comparison rather than stopping at the common dictionary meanings.

Word family: **sympathy / sympathies / sympathise / sympathize / sympathised / sympathized / sympathising / sympathizing / sympathetic / sympathetically / sympathiser / sympathizer / unsympathetic**

Base word: sympathy

Plural: sympathies

Verb: sympathise (BrE) / sympathize (AmE)

Adjective: sympathetic

Adverb: sympathetically

Person noun: sympathiser / sympathizer

Opposite adjective: unsympathetic

Related lower-frequency forms: unsympathetically, sympatheticness (rare; usually *sympathy* / *understanding* instead)

Important compounds/constructions:

- * have sympathy for
- * feel sympathy for
- * express sympathy
- * deepest sympathy
- * sympathy card
- * sympathy message
- * sympathy for someone's situation
- * in sympathy with
- * out of sympathy with
- * one's sympathies lie with
- * gain / win / arouse sympathy
- * sympathetic to/towards
- * sympathetic ear
- * sympathetic character
- * sympathy strike
- * sympathy vote
- * sympathy pains
- * sympathetic nervous system
- * sympathetic response
- * sympathetic vibration / resonance
- * sympathetic strings
- * sympathetic magic
- * sympathetic restoration

Your sentence:

> “Nevertheless, **sympathy** should not become justification.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **sympathy** means **understanding and compassionate concern for people who are in a difficult situation**.

The writer accepts that students may genuinely lack quiet places to study. However, feeling sorry for or understanding their difficulty does not automatically prove that occupying restaurant tables for hours is justified.

繁體中文： **同情；體諒；對他人的困難表示理解和關懷**

中文翻譯：

> “Nevertheless, **sympathy** should not become justification.”

「然而，**同情 / 體諒不應變成為某種做法開脫的理由**。」

Here:

sympathy = 理解學生面對的困難，並對他們的處境感到關心

It does **not** automatically mean:

> agreeing with everything they do.

That distinction is central to the sentence.

A. SYMPATHY = COMPASSION FOR SUFFERING

1. **sympathy = feelings of sorrow and concern for someone in difficulty (同情) — 同情；憐惜；關懷**

This is the central everyday meaning and the passage branch.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We can feel **sympathy** for students who have nowhere quiet to study.”

「對於沒有安靜地方學習的學生，我們可以表示**同情 / 體諒**。」

Practice 2

> “She felt great **sympathy** for the family.”

「她十分**同情**那個家庭。」

Practice 3

> “His situation deserves our **sympathy**.”

「他的處境值得我們**同情**。」

sympathy = 知道別人正在受苦 / 面對困難，因此對其產生關心、難過或體諒

Common:

- * feel sympathy
- * have sympathy for
- * deserve sympathy
- * show sympathy
- * express sympathy

2. **feel sympathy for someone** = feel sorry/concerned for them (同情某人)

Practice 4

> “I feel **sympathy for** anyone working under that pressure.”

「我很**同情**任何在那種壓力下工作的人。」

sympathy for is especially natural when someone is:

- * suffering;
- * unlucky;
- * bereaved;
- * facing hardship.

3. **have sympathy for someone's situation** = understand their difficulty (體諒)

Practice 5

> “I have considerable **sympathy for** students living in cramped homes.”

「我十分**體諒**住在狹窄住宅的學生。」

Here Chinese **體諒** may be better than simply **同情**, because the emphasis is understanding the difficulty rather than pitying the person.

4. **show sympathy** = express compassionate concern (表示同情)

> “Several colleagues showed sympathy after hearing what happened.”

「幾位同事聽到事情經過後都表示**關心和同情**。」

5. **arouse / evoke / elicit sympathy** = cause other people to feel sympathy (引起同情)

Practice 6

> “Her story **aroused considerable sympathy**.”

「她的故事引起了相當大的**同情**。」

Common formal verbs:

- * arouse sympathy
- * evoke sympathy
- * elicit sympathy
- * inspire sympathy

6. **gain / win sympathy** = cause people to become sympathetic toward you (贏得同情)

Practice 7

> “His explanation won him some **sympathy**.”

「他的解釋令他**贏得了一些同情 / 理解**。」

This may involve:

- * compassion;
- * greater support;
- * softer judgment.

7. **deserve sympathy = be in a situation reasonably deserving compassion (值得同情) **

> “The workers deserve sympathy for the difficulties they faced.”

「那些工人所面對的困難確實**值得同情**。」

8. **little / no sympathy for someone = little compassion or understanding (不同情) **

Practice 8

> “She had little **sympathy for** people who deliberately ignored the rules.”

「她對故意無視規則的人幾乎**沒有同情**。」

Depending on context this can imply:

* little emotional compassion;

* little approval;

* little patience.

B. SYMPATHY = CONDOLENCE AFTER DEATH / LOSS

9. **sympathy = condolence following bereavement (慰問) — 弔慰；慰問；哀悼之意**

A major conventional branch.

Practice 9

> “Please accept my deepest **sympathy**.”

「請接受我最深切的**慰問 / 哀悼**。」

Practice 10

> “We sent our sympathy to the family.”

「我們向家屬表示**慰問**。」

In bereavement contexts, **sympathy** is usually translated more naturally as:

* 慰問

- * 哀悼
- * 弔慰之意

rather than simply 同情.

10. **my deepest sympathy / deepest sympathies = 深切慰問**

Common condolence formula:

> “My deepest sympathies are with you and your family.”

「謹向你及你的家人致以最深切的**慰問**。」

Plural **sympathies** is particularly common in condolences.

11. **express one's sympathy = express condolences (致意 / 慰問) **

Practice 11

> “She called to express her **sympathy**.”

「她致電表示**慰問**。」

Context determines whether this is:

- * general compassion;
- * bereavement condolence.

12. **sympathy card = condolence card (慰問卡) **

A card sent after:

- * death;
- * bereavement;
- * sometimes serious personal loss.

繁體中文： **慰問卡 / 弔唁卡**

13. **sympathy message / letter = condolence message (慰問信息 / 慰問信) **

> “They sent a sympathy message to the family.”

「他們向家屬發送了**慰問信息**。」

14. **sympathy flowers = flowers sent as condolence (慰問花 / 弔唁花) **

A transparent but established funeral/bereavement usage.

C. SYMPATHY = UNDERSTANDING SOMEONE'S FEELINGS / POSITION

15. **sympathy = ability/willingness to understand someone's feelings (理解 / 共鳴) **

Practice 12

> “He listened to her problems with genuine **sympathy**.”

「他真誠地**理解和體諒**她的困難。」

This is not necessarily:

> feeling exactly the same emotion.

It can simply mean:

> receptive, caring understanding.

16. **be in sympathy with someone's feelings = share/understand them (有共鳴) **

> “I am in sympathy with her frustration.”

「我對她的挫折感**很能理解 / 有共鳴**。」

Formal.

17. **a sympathetic ear = someone willing to listen understandingly (善解人意的聆聽者) **

Practice 13

> “Sometimes people just need a ****sympathetic ear****.”

「有時候，人們只需要一個願意****體諒地聆聽****自己的人。」

Very common expression.

Not literally:

> an ear that feels sympathy.

D. SYMPATHY = AGREEMENT / SUPPORT

18. ****sympathy = agreement with or support for an idea/cause/person (認同 / 支持) ****

This is an important separate branch.

Practice 14

> “She has some ****sympathy with**** that argument.”

「她對那個論點有一定程度的****認同****。」

Practice 15

> “His sympathies lie with the smaller organizations.”

「他較****支持 / 認同****那些較小型的機構。」

Here ****sympathy**** does not primarily mean:

> feeling sorry for them.

It means:

> one's attitudes are broadly favourable toward them.

19. ****have sympathy with/for an idea = agree to some extent (認同) ****

Practice 16

> “I have some sympathy with that view, although I do not fully agree.”

「我對那個觀點有一定程度的**認同**，但並不完全同意。」

Very useful nuance:

> sympathy with a view ≠ complete agreement.

20. **one's sympathies are with someone = one's support/allegiance lies with them (支持某方)
**

Practice 17

> “My sympathies are with the residents in this dispute.”

「在這場爭議中，我比較**支持 / 理解居民一方**。」

Context can shade between:

- * emotional sympathy;
- * alignment/support.

21. **one's sympathies lie with X = be inclined to support X (傾向支持) **

Formal:

> “His sympathies clearly lie with the smaller firms.”

「他顯然較**支持**小型企業。」

22. **in sympathy with = agreeing with/supporting (認同；支持) **

Practice 18

> “Many employees were in sympathy with the proposal.”

「很多員工都**認同 / 支持**這項建議。」

23. **out of sympathy with = no longer sharing someone's views (不認同) **

Especially BrE/formal:

> “He found himself increasingly out of sympathy with the organization.”

「他發現自己越來越**不認同**該組織的理念。」

This does **not** mean:

> he no longer felt sorry for it.

It means:

> his views no longer aligned.

E. SYMPATHISE / SYMPATHIZE — FEEL COMPASSION

24. **sympathise/sympathize with someone = understand and feel sorry for them (同情 / 體諒) **

Practice 19

> “I **sympathise with** students who struggle to find quiet study space.”

「我很**體諒 / 同情**那些難以找到安靜學習空間的學生。」

BrE:

> sympathise

AmE:

> sympathize

25. **sympathise with someone's situation/problem (體諒處境) **

> “I sympathize with your situation.”

「我很**理解 / 體諒你的處境**。」

This often sounds more respectful than:

> “I pity you.”

26. **I can sympathise = I understand how difficult that feels**

Practice 20

> “I can sympathise—I had the same problem last year.”

「我很能**理解你的感受**——我去年也遇過同樣的問題。」

This can approach **empathy**, particularly where the speaker has experienced something similar.

F. SYMPATHISE = AGREE / SUPPORT

27. **sympathise with a cause/view = support or agree with it (認同 / 支持) **

Practice 21

> “He sympathised with the aims of the campaign.”

「他**認同 / 支持**這項活動的目標。」

No pity is involved.

28. **sympathise with someone's position = understand and partly agree (理解並認同立場) **

> “I sympathize with their position, but I disagree with the proposed solution.”

「我**理解並在一定程度上認同**他們的立場，但不同意他們提出的解決方法。」

This is extremely close to the logic of your passage.

G. SYMPATHISER / SYMPATHIZER

29. **sympathiser = person who supports or agrees with a group/cause (支持者) **

Practice 22

> “The organization has many supporters and sympathisers.”

「該組織有很多支持者和**認同者 / 同情者**。」

The word often means:

> a person broadly favourable to the aims of a group without necessarily being a formal member.

30. **sympathizer does not necessarily mean member**

Important distinction:

> member

> = 正式成員

> sympathizer

> = 對其理念 / 目標表示支持或同情的人

The exact relationship depends on context.

31. **political/group sympathizer**

The term can be applied to ideological, political, social, or other groups.

It is often more neutral descriptively than **member**, though context can make it accusatory.

H. SYMPATHETIC = COMPASSIONATE

32. **sympathetic = showing understanding and compassion (有同情心的) — 同情的；體諒的；善解人意的**

Practice 23

> “The teacher was very **sympathetic**.”

「老師非常**體諒 / 善解人意**。」

Practice 24

> “She gave him a sympathetic smile.”

「她向他投以一個充滿**理解與同情**的微笑。」

Common:

- * sympathetic person
- * sympathetic listener
- * sympathetic response
- * sympathetic smile
- * sympathetic attitude

33. **be sympathetic to/towards someone = be understanding toward them (體諒) **

> “The manager was sympathetic to her situation.”

「經理很**體諒她的處境**。」

34. **sympathetic treatment = kind/understanding treatment (體諒的對待) **

> “The case deserves sympathetic treatment.”

Depending on context:

「這件事值得以**理解 / 體諒的態度**處理。」

I. SYMPATHETIC = SUPPORTIVE / FAVOURABLY DISPOSED

35. **sympathetic to an idea/cause = favourably disposed toward it (認同 / 支持) **

Practice 25

> “She is broadly **sympathetic to** the proposal.”

「她大致上**支持 / 認同**這項建議。」

This does not mean:

> she feels sorry for the proposal.

36. **sympathetic audience = audience receptive to the speaker's views (友善 / 認同的聽眾) **

> “He was speaking to a largely sympathetic audience.”

「他的聽眾大多對他的觀點**持支持 / 友善態度**。」

37. **sympathetic hearing = fair/receptive consideration (願意理解地聽取) **

> “At least give the idea a sympathetic hearing.”

「至少應該以**願意理解的態度**聽取這個想法。」

Formal.

J. SYMPATHETIC = LIKEABLE / PORTRAYED FAVOURABLY

38. **sympathetic character = character audiences can understand/like/care about (令人產生共鳴的角色) **

Practice 26

> “The film turns him into a more **sympathetic character**.”

「電影把他塑造成一個更**令人同情 / 產生共鳴的角色**。」

This can mean the audience:

- * likes the character;
- * understands their motives;
- * feels compassion for them.

39. **sympathetic portrayal = favourable/humanizing portrayal (富理解 / 同情的描寫) **

> “The documentary offers a sympathetic portrayal of the family.”

「紀錄片以較具**理解與同情**的角度描寫這個家庭。」

It need not mean uncritical praise.

40. **unsympathetic character = difficult to like or empathize with (難以同情 / 討好的角色) **

> “The protagonist is deliberately unsympathetic.”

「主角刻意被塑造成一個**難以令人同情 / 喜歡**的人物。」

K. SYMPATHETIC = HARMONIOUS / WELL-SUITED

41. **sympathetic design/treatment = in harmony with existing character (和諧 / 相稱) **

Especially architecture, restoration, design:

Practice 27

> “The extension was designed to be sympathetic to the original building.”

「擴建部分的設計力求與原建築的風格**協調 / 相稱**。」

Here **sympathetic** means:

> respecting and fitting harmoniously with existing character.

No emotional sympathy is involved.

42. **sympathetic restoration = restoration respecting original style/material (保留原貌的修復) **

An established heritage/architecture expression.

繁體中文： **尊重原有風貌的修復 / 協調性修復**

43. **sympathetic colour/material/design = harmonizing well (協調的) **

Formal/artistic:

> “The new materials are sympathetic to the historic setting.”

「新材料與歷史環境十分**協調**。」

L. SYMPATHETIC NERVOUS SYSTEM — MEDICINE

44. **sympathetic nervous system = 交感神經系統**

A major anatomical meaning of **sympathetic**.

The sympathetic nervous system is a division of the autonomic nervous system involved in regulating many involuntary bodily functions, particularly responses that prepare the body for activity or stress.

Common effects can include changes in:

- * heart rate
- * pupil size
- * blood-vessel tone
- * digestive activity

depending on tissue/receptor/context.

This is completely separate from:

> sympathetic = compassionate.

45. **sympathetic nerve / sympathetic fibres = 交感神經 / 交感神經纖維**

Anatomical compounds belonging to the same branch.

46. **sympathetic activation = 交感神經活化**

> increased sympathetic activity

= **交感神經活動增加**

Common in physiology/medicine.

47. **sympathetic tone = 交感神經張力**

A physiological term describing baseline sympathetic nervous-system activity.

48. **sympatholytic / sympathomimetic?**

These medical words belong etymologically to the sympathetic nervous-system terminology but are no longer transparent derivatives of everyday **sympathy**.

* **sympathomimetic** = mimicking/stimulating sympathetic effects

* **sympatholytic** = reducing sympathetic activity

They are highly specialist pharmaceutical/physiological vocabulary and are best indexed separately if your database tracks extended technical families.

M. SYMPATHETIC RESPONSE / REACTION

49. **sympathetic response = response corresponding to another person's emotion (情感共鳴)
**

In ordinary psychology/social language:

> “Her story produced a sympathetic response.”

「她的故事引起了**同情 / 共鳴的反應**。」

But in physiology:

> sympathetic response

may instead refer to **sympathetic nervous-system activation**.

Context is essential.

N. SYMPATHY PAINS / SYMPATHETIC PREGNANCY

50. **sympathy pains = symptoms felt because someone close is suffering (同感痛症 / 陪伴性不適) **

Informal expression for bodily discomfort someone experiences in apparent association with another person's pain/condition.

Often used jokingly or colloquially.

51. **sympathetic pregnancy = symptoms in a partner during pregnancy (陪孕反應) **

Often associated with the term:

> **couvade syndrome**

Possible symptoms reported can include nausea or other physical complaints in the non-pregnant partner.

This is a specialist/colloquial family use.

O. PHYSICS: SYMPATHETIC VIBRATION / RESONANCE

52. **sympathetic vibration = one object vibrates because another nearby object vibrates (共振) **

Example

> “The second string began to vibrate sympathetically.”

「第二條弦因第一條弦的振動而產生**共振**。」

The objects do not feel emotions.

The term means:

> vibration induced through resonant coupling.

53. **sympathetic resonance = 共鳴 / 共振**

A closely related physics/acoustics term.

One resonant system responds strongly to vibrations from another when appropriate frequencies align.

54. **sympathetic string = 共鳴弦**

On certain musical instruments, **sympathetic strings** are strings that are normally not directly played but vibrate in response to other strings/notes.

繁體中文： ** 共鳴弦

55. **sympathetically vibrate = 產生共振**

Technical adverb:

> “The string vibrates sympathetically.”

= 「琴弦產生**共振**。」

Clearly unrelated to:

> speak sympathetically.

P. FINANCE / MARKETS: MOVE “IN SYMPATHY”

56. **move/rise/fall in sympathy with X = change because a related market/asset changes (跟隨變動) **

Financial journalism may say:

> “The shares fell in sympathy with the wider market.”

「該股票跟隨整體市場**同步下跌**。」

Here:

in sympathy with = in corresponding response to

No compassion is involved.

57. **currency/commodity moves in sympathy with another**

> “The currency rose in sympathy with commodity prices.”

「該貨幣跟隨商品價格**同步上升**。」

This develops from the older notion of:

> corresponding/harmonious response.

Q. LABOUR: SYMPATHY STRIKE

58. **sympathy strike = strike supporting workers in another dispute (聲援罷工) **

A **sympathy strike** is industrial action by workers who are not necessarily the primary parties to the original labour dispute, undertaken in support/solidarity with other workers.

繁體中文： ** **聲援罷工 / 同情罷工

The legal status and terminology vary across jurisdictions.

The meaning comes from:

> sympathy = support/solidarity.

59. **sympathy action = industrial action in support of another group (聲援行動) **

Related labour-relations term.

R. SYMPATHY VOTE

60. **sympathy vote = support/vote influenced by compassion (同情票) **

A **sympathy vote** means support given partly because people feel compassion for a person or group due to misfortune or difficult circumstances.

It can occur in:

- * elections;
- * competitions;
- * awards;
- * audience voting.

繁體中文： ** **同情票

It does not necessarily mean agreement with the recipient's views.

S. ANTHROPOLOGY: SYMPATHETIC MAGIC

61. **sympathetic magic = magic based on supposed correspondence/connection (交感巫術)
**

An anthropological term traditionally describing magical practices based on ideas that:

* like affects like; or

* things once connected continue to influence one another.

繁體中文 : ** commonly **交感巫術 / 交感魔法

This is specialist anthropological/history-of-religion vocabulary.

62. **homeopathic / imitative magic as subtype concepts**

Historical anthropological classifications often connect **sympathetic magic** with concepts such as similarity/imitation and contact/contagion.

These are technical theoretical classifications rather than everyday senses of **sympathetic**.

T. HISTORICAL: SYMPATHETIC INK

63. **sympathetic ink = invisible ink (歷史) — 隱形墨水**

An older term for ink that is initially invisible or difficult to see and becomes visible after some treatment.

Database status: historical/low-frequency but genuine.

Modern English usually says:

> invisible ink.

U. RARE/FORMAL: SYMPATHY = AFFINITY / HARMONY

64. **sympathy = natural affinity or harmonious correspondence (契合 / 共鳴) **

Older/formal/literary:

> “There was an immediate sympathy between their ideas.”

Approximately:

「他們的思想之間立即產生一種**契合 / 共鳴**。」

This historical branch helps explain:

- * sympathetic vibration
- * in sympathy with market movements
- * harmonious architectural design.

It is much less common as a standalone modern everyday sense.

65. **sympathy between things = correspondence / mutual response**

Formal/older:

> “a sympathy between the two systems”

= some correspondence/interaction.

Usually modern English chooses more precise terms:

- * relationship
- * affinity
- * correspondence
- * resonance

V. **UNSYMPATHETIC**

66. **unsympathetic = not showing compassion or understanding (缺乏同情的) **

Practice 28

> “The manager was surprisingly **unsympathetic**.”

「經理出奇地**缺乏同情 / 不體諒人**。」

67. **unsympathetic to someone's problems = not understanding/caring about them (不體諒) **

> “She was unsympathetic to his difficulties.”

「她對他的困難很**不體諒**。」

68. **unsympathetic to an idea/cause = not supportive (不認同) **

Practice 29

> “The committee was largely **unsympathetic to** the proposal.”

「委員會大致上**不支持 / 不認同**這項建議。」

No emotional cruelty is necessarily implied.

69. **unsympathetic character = unlikeable / difficult to empathize with**

Literary/film criticism:

> “The writer deliberately creates an unsympathetic narrator.”

「作者刻意塑造一個**難以令人產生同情 / 認同的敘述者**。」

70. **unsympathetically = without sympathy / in an unfavourable way**

> “He responded unsympathetically.”

「他的回應顯得**缺乏體諒**。」

Lower frequency than:

> without sympathy

> in an unsympathetic way.

W. ****SYMPATHETICALLY****

71. ****sympathetically = with compassion/understanding (同情地 ; 體諒地) ****

Practice 30

> “She listened sympathetically.”

「她很****體諒地****聆聽。」

72. ****sympathetically = favourably/supportively (支持地) ****

> “The proposal was sympathetically received.”

「這項建議獲得了較為****正面 / 支持性的回應****。」

Formal.

73. ****sympathetically — physics****

As above:

> vibrate sympathetically

= ****共振****

Same adverb, entirely different domain.

X. IMPORTANT FIXED EXPRESSIONS

74. ****my sympathy goes out to someone = I feel deeply sorry for them (深表同情) ****

Practice 31

> “My sympathy goes out to everyone affected.”

「我向所有受影響的人表示深切****同情 / 慰問****。」

Especially after tragedy or hardship.

75. **you have my sympathy = 我很同情你 / 你值得同情**

> “If you have to work all weekend, you have my sympathy.”

「如果你整個週末都要工作，我真的**很同情你**。」

Can be sincere or occasionally humorous.

76. **I have every sympathy with/for... = I fully understand/support... **

Especially BrE:

> “I have every sympathy with people facing high rents.”

「我完全**理解 / 體諒**面對高租金的人。」

Strong but still does not necessarily imply agreement with every action they take.

77. **my sympathies are with... **

Can mean:

condolence

> my sympathies are with the family.

support/alignment

> my sympathies are with the workers.

Context determines meaning.

78. **in sympathy with = support/agreement**

Already covered, but highly important.

79. ****in sympathy with = corresponding movement/change****

Finance/physics-like extension.

80. ****out of sympathy with = no longer sharing views/values****

Formal BrE.

Y. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

****sympathy vs empathy****

One of the most important distinctions.

****sympathy****

typically means:

> feeling concern, sorrow, or understanding ****for**** someone.

****empathy****

more specifically emphasizes:

> understanding or imaginatively sharing another person's perspective or feelings.

Example:

> "I feel sympathy for her loss."

= 我為她的遭遇感到難過。

> "I can empathize with how isolated she feels."

= 我能理解 / 設身處地感受她的孤單。

Real-life usage overlaps considerably, so the distinction should not be treated as absolute.

****sympathy vs compassion****

sympathy

= concern/sorrow/understanding for someone's suffering.

compassion

often adds:

> a stronger desire to relieve or respond to that suffering.

So compassion is often more action-oriented.

sympathy vs pity

pity

= feeling sorry for someone because of suffering/misfortune.

sympathy

usually sounds more respectful and emotionally connected.

Pity can sometimes imply:

- * distance;
- * superiority;
- * helplessness.

That negative implication is contextual, not automatic.

sympathy vs concern

concern

can mean worry/care about someone.

sympathy

specifically responds to another person's suffering or difficulty.

> concern for students' welfare

> sympathy for students facing hardship

Close but not identical.

sympathy vs consideration

In your passage:

sympathy

= understand and care about someone's hardship.

consideration

= adjust your own behaviour because you are thinking about others' needs.

You can have sympathy for students while still expecting them to show consideration for restaurant patrons.

That is exactly the writer's distinction.

sympathy vs support

sympathy

can mean support, but often only partial emotional/intellectual alignment.

support

is broader and often stronger/action-oriented.

> "I have sympathy with their argument."

may mean:

> I understand and partly agree.

It does not necessarily mean:

> I actively support their proposal.

****sympathy vs agreement****

****agreement****

= accepting that a proposition/position is correct.

****sympathy****

can merely mean:

> inclination toward / understanding of the position.

So:

> "I have some sympathy with that argument, but I disagree with the conclusion."

is perfectly coherent.

****sympathy vs solidarity****

****solidarity****

= active unity/support based on shared interests or principles.

****sympathy****

may be purely emotional.

A ****sympathy strike****, however, expresses solidarity through action.

****sympathetic vs compassionate****

****sympathetic person****

= understanding and responsive to another's difficulty.

****compassionate person****

= strongly caring about suffering, often with willingness to help.

Large overlap.

****sympathetic vs supportive****

****sympathetic to an idea****

= favourably disposed / broadly agrees.

****supportive of an idea/person****

= actively or clearly provides support.

****Supportive**** often implies a stronger practical stance.

****sympathetic vs agreeable****

****agreeable****

can mean:

- * pleasant;
- * willing to agree.

****sympathetic****

can mean:

- * compassionate;
- * aligned with a viewpoint;
- * harmonious in design.

Different semantic network.

****sympathetic vs likeable****

A ****sympathetic character**** is often likeable, but not always.

A morally flawed character can be ****sympathetic**** if the audience:

- * understands them;
- * feels compassion;

* identifies with their situation.

sympathetic vs parasympathetic

Medical distinction:

sympathetic nervous system

one division of the autonomic nervous system.

parasympathetic nervous system

another division with different anatomical and physiological organization.

They are not equivalent to:

> sympathetic = kind

> parasympathetic = unkind ❌

Z. GRAMMAR

81. **sympathy for + person/situation**

Most natural for compassion:

> sympathy for the family

> sympathy for students in difficult circumstances

82. **sympathy with + view/cause**

Especially agreement/alignment:

> sympathy with the proposal

> sympathy with their aims

Usage overlaps with **for**, but this tendency is useful.

83. **in sympathy with**

Can mean:

1. in agreement/support;
2. changing/responding correspondingly.

Context essential.

84. ****sympathise/sympathize with + person/position****

- > sympathize with her
- > sympathize with their position

Not normally:

> sympathize her ❌

The verb normally takes ****with****.

85. ****sympathetic to/towards + person/idea****

- > sympathetic to students
- > sympathetic towards the proposal

Both possible.

****sympathetic to**** is especially common for ideas/causes.

86. ****sympathetic of?****

Generally avoid:

> sympathetic of ❌

Use:

- > sympathetic to/towards someone
- > sympathetic to an idea.

AA. COUNTABILITY

sympathy — compassion

Normally uncountable:

- > feel sympathy
- > show sympathy

Not normally:

- > “a sympathy” ❌

for one feeling of compassion.

sympathies — condolences

Plural:

- > deepest sympathies
- > offer one's sympathies

sympathies — allegiances/support

Plural:

- > “His sympathies lie with the smaller firms.”

Here **sympathies** means favourable attitudes/alignment.

sympathiser/sympathizer

Countable:

- > a sympathizer
- > several sympathizers

AB. FAMILY MAP

Family member	Main modern meanings
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-----	-----
sympathy	compassion; condolence; understanding; agreement/support; correspondence/affinity in specialist/older uses
sympathies	condolences; supportive/aligned feelings
sympathise / sympathize	feel compassion/understanding; agree/support
sympathetic	compassionate; supportive; likeable/relatable; harmonious; autonomic-nervous-system term; resonating/responding
sympathetically	compassionately; favourably; by sympathetic resonance
sympathiser / sympathizer	supporter or person broadly aligned with a group/cause
unsympathetic	lacking compassion; not supportive; unlikeable/unrelatable
unsympathetically	without sympathy/support

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
sympathy — compassion	因別人的痛苦 / 困境而產生的同情、關懷和體諒
sympathy for someone's situation	對某人的困難表示理解和體諒
show/express sympathy	表達同情或關心
arouse/evoke sympathy	引起別人的同情
gain/win sympathy	令別人開始更同情 / 理解 / 支持自己
no sympathy for	對某人 / 某事缺乏同情、體諒或認同
sympathy — bereavement	對喪親者表達的哀悼 / 慰問
deepest sympathies	最深切的慰問
sympathy card/message	慰問卡 / 慰問信息
sympathy — agreement/support	對某個立場、理念或一方有一定程度的認同 / 支持
one's sympathies lie with X	自己的立場 / 情感較傾向支持 X
in sympathy with — agreement	與某立場一致 / 表示支持
out of sympathy with	不再認同某人的觀點 / 理念
sympathise with someone	理解並同情 / 體諒某人的困境
sympathise with a view/cause	認同 / 支持某觀點或理念
sympathizer	對某團體 / 理念表示支持但未必是正式成員的人
sympathetic — compassionate	對他人的困難表現出理解、同情和體諒的
sympathetic to an idea	對某想法 / 理念持較支持、正面的態度

sympathetic ear	願意耐心、體諒地聆聽別人的人	
sympathetic character	能令觀眾理解、認同或產生同情的角色	
sympathetic portrayal	以較具理解、同情或人性化方式描寫	
sympathetic design/restoration	與原有風格 / 環境協調並尊重其特質的設計 / 修復	
sympathetic nervous system	自主神經系統中的交感神經系統	
sympathetic activation/tone	交感神經活化 / 交感神經張力	
sympathetic response	可指情感共鳴；生理學亦可指交感神經反應	
sympathy pains	因親近者的痛苦 / 狀況而出現的所謂同感性不適	
sympathetic pregnancy	非懷孕伴侶出現類似孕期症狀的陪孕反應	
sympathetic vibration/resonance	一個振動系統引起另一系統在相應頻率產生共振	
sympathetic strings	不直接演奏而由其他琴弦 / 聲音引起共振的共鳴弦	
in sympathy with — finance	跟隨相關市場 / 資產的變化而同步上升或下降	
sympathy strike	為聲援另一群工人而採取的罷工行動	
sympathy vote	因同情某人處境而給予的票 / 支持	
sympathetic magic	建基於相似 / 聯繫能產生影響等觀念的交感巫術	
sympathetic ink	舊稱隱形墨水	
unsympathetic — person	對別人困難缺乏同情和理解的	
unsympathetic to an idea	不認同 / 不支持某想法	
unsympathetic character	難以令觀眾同情、認同或喜歡的角色	

For your original sentence

> “Nevertheless, **sympathy should not become justification**.”

The exact meaning is:

sympathy = 我們可以理解和體諒學生確實面對居住空間狹窄、圖書館爆滿等困難

but:

> **sympathy ≠ justification**

The writer distinguishes two questions:

1. **Do the students have a genuine difficulty?**
→ Yes; their situation can deserve **sympathy**.
2. **Does that difficulty automatically make prolonged use of restaurant tables acceptable?**
→ The writer argues no.

So a particularly natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> **「然而，對學生處境的體諒，不應變成替這種做法合理化的理由。」**

For the core database, I would keep **4 major ordinary semantic branches** for **sympathy**:

1. **compassion/concern for someone's suffering or difficulty**
2. **condolence after bereavement or loss**
3. **understanding/emotional identification with someone**
4. **agreement, affinity, or support for a person, position, or cause**

But for the **whole family**, I would explicitly index the independently important branches
sympathetic nervous system, **sympathetic resonance/vibration**, **sympathetic
design/restoration**, **sympathy strike**, **sympathy vote**, **sympathetic magic**, the financial
move in sympathy with, and the full **sympathize / sympathizer / sympathetic / unsympathetic**
network rather than hiding those under the general “同情” meaning.